

How firm a foundation

Text: "K" in Rippon's
Selection of Hymns, 1787
FOUNDATION (BELLEVUE) 11 11. 11 11

Music: American folk melody, in Joseph Funk's
Genuine Church Music, 1st ed., 1832

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 2/2 time, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The melody consists of 11 measures, each containing a single note. The notes are: G2 (half), A2 (half), B1 (half), C3 (half), D3 (half), E3 (half), F3 (half), G3 (half), A3 (half), B3 (half), and C4 (half). The lyrics are arranged in five systems, each with five numbered lines. The first system covers measures 1-5, the second system covers measures 6-10, and the third system covers measures 11-15. The lyrics are as follows:

1 How firm a foun - da - tion, ye saints of the Lord,
2 "Fear not, I am with thee; O be not dis - mayed,
3 "When through the deep wa - ters I call thee to go,
4 "When through fi - ery tri - als thy path - way shall lie,
5 "The soul that on Je - sus still leans for re - pose,
1 is laid for your faith in his ex - cel - lent Word!
2 for I am thy God, and will still give thee aid.
3 the riv - ers of sor - row shall not o - ver - flow,
4 my grace, all - suf - fi - cient, shall be thy sup - ply.
5 I will not, I will not de - sert to its foes.
1 What more can he say than to you he hath said,
2 I'll strength - en thee, help thee, and cause thee to stand,
3 for I will be with thee, thy trou - bles to bless,
4 The flame shall not hurt thee. I on - ly de - sign
5 That soul, though all hell should en - deav - or to shake,
1 to you who for ref - uge to Je - sus have fled?
2 up - held by my right - eous, om - ni - po - tent hand.
3 and sanc - ti - fy to thee thy deep - est dis - tress.
4 thy dross to con - sume, and thy gold to re - fine.
5 I'll nev - er, no nev - er, no nev - er for - sake!"